

Google Play Store App Analysis

Comprehensive Project Documentation & Exploratory Data Analysis Report

| 1. Project Overview

The objective of this project was to **analyze the factors associated with app popularity, user satisfaction, and market opportunities on the Google Play Store** by analyzing application metadata and user reviews. Using Pandas, I built an end-to-end data analytics pipeline that cleaned raw datasets, explored key product metrics, integrated review sentiment, and generated business insights. The analysis focused on identifying factors influencing app adoption, user satisfaction, monetization strategy, and market opportunities, enabling data-driven product decisions.

| 2. Project Objectives

- **1. Data Preparation**
Clean and preprocess real-world app metadata and user review datasets to ensure accurate and reliable analysis.
- **2. Analyze Product Performance**
Explore key product metrics such as ratings, installs, pricing models, reviews, and app categories to understand the factors associated with app success.
- **3. Measure User Satisfaction**
Combine app metadata with review sentiment to move beyond star ratings and gain deeper insights into user experience.
- **4. Identify Market Opportunities**
Analyze market competition and demand across app categories to identify underserved segments and support product strategy decisions.
- **5. Generate Actionable Business Insights**
Translate analytical findings into recommendations related to product positioning, monetization, user engagement, and market expansion.

| 3. Data Characteristics & Technologies

The empirical depth of this analysis relies on the multi-dimensional mapping of two distinct, interconnected datasets:

- **Google Play Store Apps Dataset(apps.csv):** Contains granular metadata detailing specific structural attributes of over 10,000 distinct mobile applications. Key features include Category, Rating, Reviews, Installs, Price, Size, Content Rating, and Supported Android Versions.
- **Google Play Store Reviews Dataset(reviews.csv):** Captures qualitative dimensions via thousands of text-based customer reviews. Features include raw text reviews mapped to

pre-calculated indices for Sentiment, Sentiment Polarity (ranging from -1.0 to +1.0), and Sentiment Subjectivity.

Core Technical Stack: The workflow is executed entirely within a Jupyter Notebook ecosystem utilizing standard data science libraries: Pandas for high-performance data manipulation, and Matplotlib and Seaborn for generating high-fidelity, presentation-ready vector visualizations.

| 4. Data Cleaning & Preprocessing Pipeline

Raw internet-scraped datasets are frequently compromised by corrupted structures, misaligned types, and duplicated records. To establish a reliable analytical baseline, the following systematic pipeline was executed:

- 1. De-duplication:** Extracted unique entries based on application name, keeping the records with the highest review counts to capture the most updated metadata.
- 2. Type Normalization:** Stripped text anomalies (e.g., '+', ',', '\$') from fields like Installs and Price, converting them into rigorous numerical formats (integers and floats).
- 3. Null Management:** Handled incomplete records strategically—imputing missing ratings using categorical medians and filtering out incomplete reviews lacking sentiment data before executing the final join.

| 5. Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) & Visualizations

5.1 Distribution of Ratings

The distribution of user ratings across the Google Play Store is highly skewed toward positive feedback.

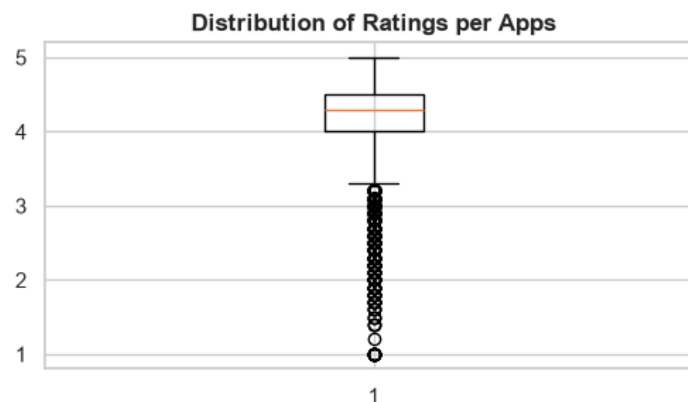


Figure 1 : Boxplot showing distribution of ratings

As highlighted in Figure 1, 50% of apps have ratings lying in the 4.0-4.5 range, reflecting that star rating alone cannot be used to differentiate between apps and determine user satisfaction.

5.2 Inter-Metric Correlation Structure

To understand the statistical relationships governing app performance, a linear correlation analysis was performed across core metrics. This illuminates whether specific variables inherently drive or react to one another.

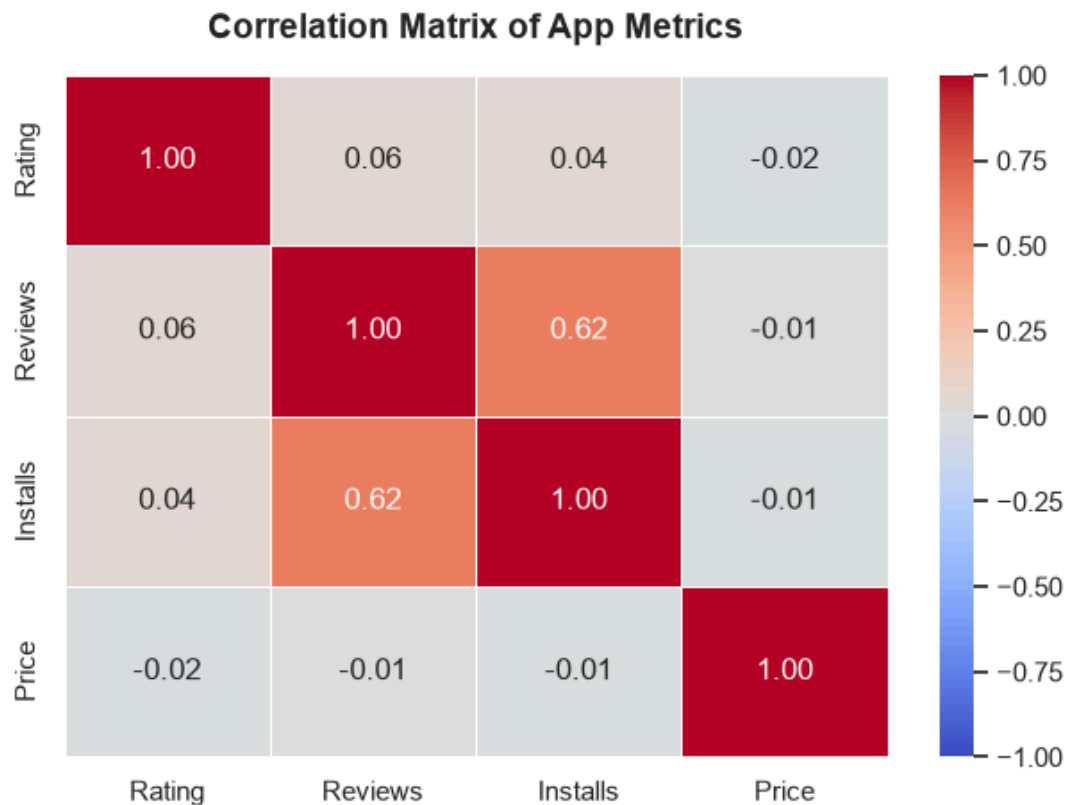


Figure 2 : Heatmap showing correlation of different numeric columns in App dataset

The correlation matrix in Figure 2 reveals a strong, positive relationship between Reviews and Installs (~0.62). This confirms that highly downloaded apps naturally collect a large absolute volume of user feedback, creating a powerful social proof flywheel.

Correlation parameters between Ratings and Installs hovers near zero indicating that high rating alone does not guarantee user adoption. Strategies like marketing and ad campaigns are required to drive popularity.

Price does not show strong correlation with variables like installs and ratings but deducing that price doesn't affect installs would be incorrect since price is highly skewed towards zero, since 92% apps are free. To get a more accurate insight, apps need to be categorized into free and paid and then analysis should be performed.

5.3 Supply vs. Demand Dynamics

Strategic product positioning requires evaluating the relationship between Supply (the total number of apps competing within a specific category) and Demand (the total aggregate installs that those apps capture).

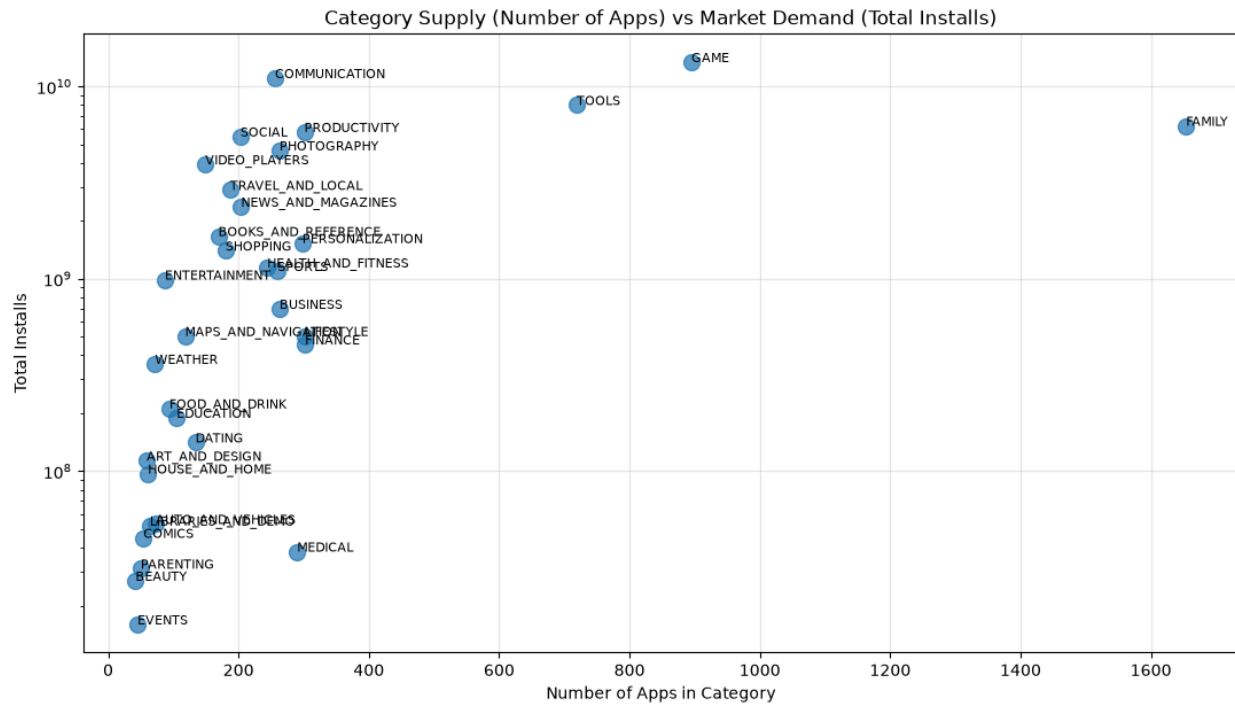


Figure 3 : Scatter Plot to demonstrate the relationship of categories with Total Installs and No. of Apps

The visualization in Figure 3 exposes significant commercial gaps. Categories like COMMUNICATION and SOCIAL represent high-efficiency, demand-dense markets; they feature a relatively moderate number of unique applications but achieve massive, multi-billion install numbers. Meanwhile, the FAMILY sector is exceptionally supply-heavy, presenting highly intensive entry barriers for new independent developers due to severe product fragmentation.

6. Integrated Sentiment Analysis

Star ratings fail to capture the nuanced qualitative experiences of users. By executing a dataset join between app metadata and localized user reviews, we extracted individual sentiment polarity indicators to uncover deeper user perceptions.

6.1 Top 10 Most Loved Apps

Applications maintaining the highest mean sentiment polarity showcase exemplary user satisfaction. These digital products represent benchmarks for exceptional UI design, user experience, and utility.

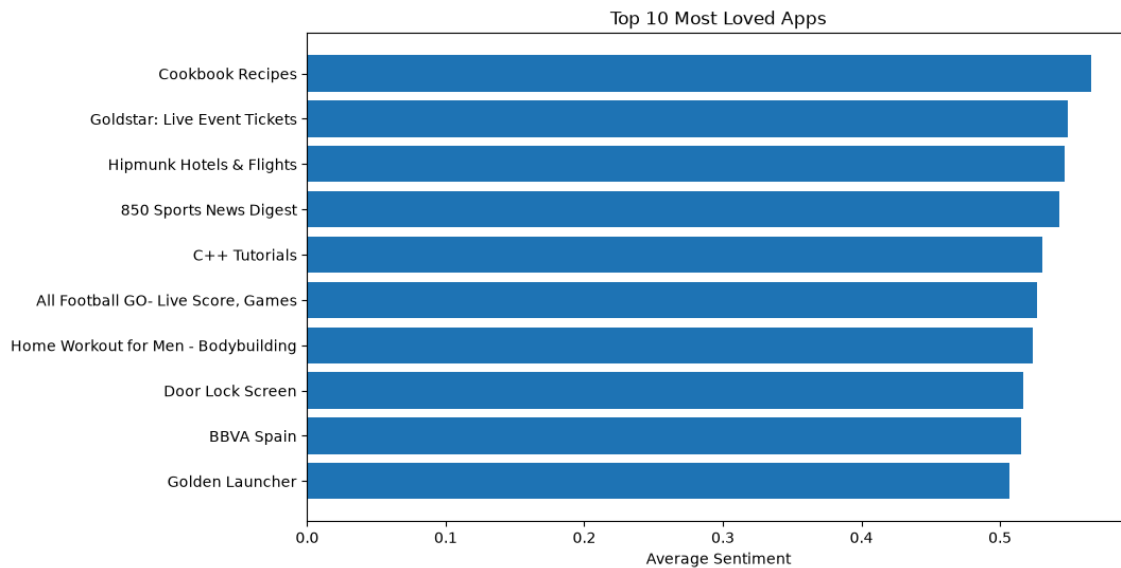


Figure 4 : Horizontal Histogram demonstrating the top 10 most loved apps

As detailed in Figure 4, applications centered on clear, focused execution—such as Cookbook Recipes and specialized service platforms like Goldstar and Hipmunk—command the highest sentiment scores, heavily outperforming generalized social or utility platforms.

6.2 Top 10 Most Criticized Apps

Conversely, identifying apps that generate intense negative sentiment exposes critical friction points, structural instabilities, or misaligned monetization schemes that irritate customer bases.

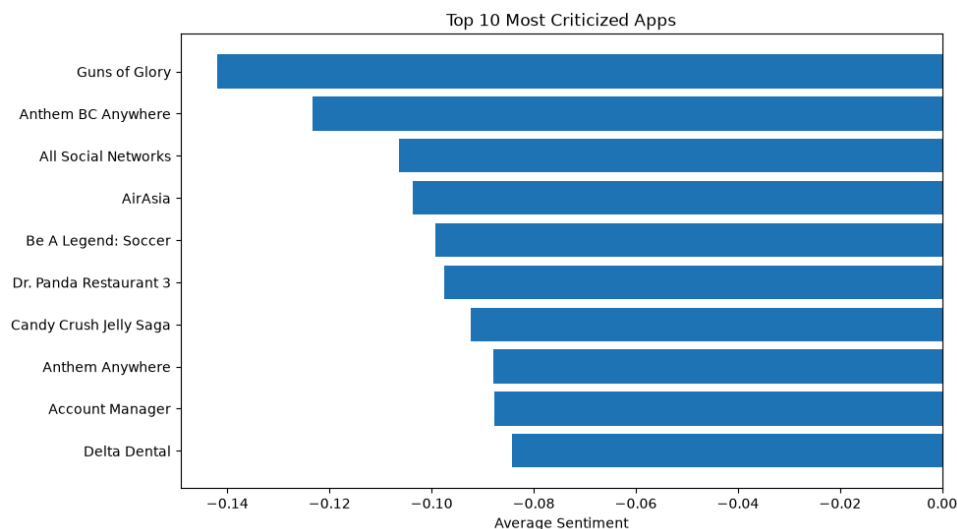


Figure 5 : Horizontal Histogram demonstrating the top 10 most criticized apps

As illustrated in Figure 5, software like Guns of Glory and various healthcare or network managers (e.g., Anthem BC Anywhere) trigger highly negative sentiment scores. This typically highlights bugs, aggressive monetization, or broken user flows, serving as a powerful warning of what to avoid during product development.

| 7. Key Business Insights & Market Opportunities

Strategic Insight 1: Leverage the Social Proof Flywheel

The 0.62 correlation between installs and reviews highlights a powerful positive feedback loop. Developers should prioritize in-app feedback prompts immediately following positive user milestones to drive visible engagement metrics and boost search visibility.

Strategic Insight 2: Target High Demand-Density Niches

Market supply-demand analysis reveals that categories like Communication and Productivity are highly lucrative. They generate immense install volumes relative to their internal app counts, offering a clearer runway for high-quality software to capture significant market share compared to the over-saturated Family category.

Strategic Insight 3: Free Apps show higher user adoption

If the objective of the app is popularity and user adoption then having a freemium model is more likely to guarantee traction than a paid one. Paid models, however, can be used for premium niche apps.

| 8. Key Conclusions

- **Sustained Quality Standards:** App ratings are consistently high across the store. Category size has no noticeable downward pressure on average user satisfaction.
- **Scale Visualizations:** Utilizing logarithmic transformations is essential for interpreting highly skewed market data, preventing extreme outliers from obscuring major category trends.
- **Qualitative Superiority:** Merging sentiment polarity data provides a far more accurate metric for assessing real user satisfaction compared to isolated 5-star ratings, uncovering critical areas of user friction and delight.

| 9. Summary & Final Remarks

This project successfully establishes an end-to-end analytics workflow, moving from raw data extraction and preprocessing to actionable market strategy. This project demonstrates the complete data analysis workflow—from raw data preprocessing to business insight generation. By integrating user review sentiment with application metadata, the analysis uncovers patterns in user satisfaction, app popularity, pricing strategy, and category performance. The findings highlight how data-driven insights can support developers and businesses in making informed product and market decisions.